

The pioneer workers of this church in the community were Mr. And Mrs. Frank Christy, who in 1911 started the first Sabbath School. The first devotional services were conducted in the M. E. church building. They built the present building in 1916 which was dedicated in June, 1917. Among the charter members of the new church were John and Rosena Hogstatz, John Hiebert and wife, Jake Penner and wife, Wm. Penner and wife, Peter Toews and wife, Jacob Toews and wife, Mrs. Grimsloy, Henry Young and wife; At the present time Sabbath School is held regularly. Preaching services are conducted from time to time by Rev. J.H. Seibel of Bowdon and Rev. D.N.Wall of Jamestown.

Rev. A.A.Dirksen, no District Supt. and Evangelist with the Kansas Conference of S.D.A.'s. and spending the winter in Washington, D.C., while in attendance at the S.D.A. Theological Seminary at Takoma Park, Maryland, has supplied the following interesting data:

"The first work of the church in northwest Stutsman County was started at New Home. Henry Heinrichs, Cornelius Dirksen, Sr., my brother Henry and a few others left Logan County to enter government land south of Sykeston. Between 1897 and 1901 it was all open for miles around. Soon others came: Peter Sperling and Dan Unruh, Sr., with their families, from South Dakota; David Funk, Sr., my step-father Jacob Dirksen; Isaac Heinrichs and others from Richville, Logan County, bought land and began to build. The houses were built mainly of sod with a few frame dwellings. Barns were built of lumber. Andrew Schmidt, Sr., and Heinrich Bohl, from Russia, soon joined the party.

A church was organized. I am not positive, but believe David Funk served as Elder and Jacob Dirksen as Deacon, respectively. They met for a time in a sod house - Mrs. Frank Wall's home. Later it was agreed that a church building be erected. A site for a church and a cemetery was selected on the Cornelius Unruh property. This plan was changed and the church was built and churchyard laid out on the southwest corner of the Wm. E. Wentland land - the SE $\frac{1}{4}$ of Sec. 2-144-69, about twelve miles south of Sykeston, and about two miles northwest of New Home.

In July, 1910, my brother Henry and I purchased a general store from John Rau of New Home. Dick Jensen operated a blacksmith shop. Henry Koen had the post office. Our store was originally started by the two Jewish Silberman brothers in the John Hiebert home. In the fall of 1911 we rented a portion of a store building in Woodworth from W.C.Norem. The bank and post office were in the same building. There I served as post master. Justice of the Peace, etc., selling out in 1914. My brother continued the store in New Home and Pettibone. It was clear to me that God had called me to some other line of work, and so my conscience gave me no rest while in business - good as it was, and the fact I enjoyed the work. I remember the day when just after selling my interest I took a crow-bar and going out northeast of town, dug rock, happy at heart, for I felt a better day was coming in my spiritual experience. In December, 1914, I went to Pettibone and held meetings and sold religious books - happy to have a small part in the great work of "making ready a people prepared for the Lord." Soon I was called to Carrington where with Elder R.T. Nash we held meetings several weeks, Mrs. Dirksen had charge of music. We remained there for about three and a half years.

In the fall of 1915 Elder Nash and I came to Woodworth and held several weeks' meetings in the M.E. church and the school house. My brother-in-law, John Hiebert, had done faithful preliminary work. Then at the close of the meetings a church was organized. I was elected Elder of the church and John Hiebert was chosen Deacon. We continued to live in Carrington, driving from there to serve the church of Woodworth as regularly as we could. Rev. Brown, a dear friend of mine, was pastor of the M.E. church at the time and often came to study the Bible with us.

The Lord has been good to us. Our oldest daughter Ruth is married to Professor J. C. Michalenko of the S.R. Academy at Harvey and they have two children. William live in Minneapolis and they have two children. Vera, a registered nurse, now Mrs. A.L. Schmidt of Minneapolis, has a son. Orval D. is a junior student in the S.D.A. Academy at Enterprise, Kansas. All profess Christianity and are active member of our church."